

AARON SCHERF

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WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

03/2024 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3-5)
Kyiv, Ukraine

- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability.
- Managed portfolio of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact and cost effectiveness of \$450M credit facilitation program for small farmers.
- Supervised \$36M contract for monitoring, evaluation, and learning services, including developing new systems for performance tracking, strategy alignment, and context research.

U.S. Agency for International Development

02/2022 – 03/2024

Foreign Service Officer - Gender Equity and Program Design Officer (FS 4-9)
Bogota, Colombia

- Led collection of over 500 performance indicators across 32 development programs for annual report.
- Supported 32 programs to re-align performance indicators with gender equity and social inclusion principles, including multiple presentations to contract partner teams in Spanish.
- Led the design and context research for four programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, rural land titling, and indigenous civic society leadership.

U.S. Agency for International Development

07/2020 – 02/2022

Foreign Service Officer - Program Officer Rotations (FS 5-12)
Washington, DC, USA

- Led team of 15 staff as acting Office Director and Budget Lead for 3 months during \$1.7Bn congressional funding negotiations and supervised over \$60M in realignment of program funds.
- Led knowledge management pilot program with South Sudan office, including designing staff transition resources and implementation plan for improving handovers and file management in Juba.

Historic Macon Foundation

08/2016 – 05/2017

Real Estate Analyst
Macon, GA, USA

- Analyzed impact of historic revitalization investments on property values through econometric assessment.
- Supported Neighborhood Incubator community program to develop local leadership capacity.

LandLink Analytic Services, LLC

12/2016 – 10/2018

Co-Founder, Lead Economist
Macon, GA, USA

- Conducted 7 contracted research projects analyzing impact of public and private property investment on housing prices and municipal tax revenues.
- Founded data analytics consulting company with team of economists and software engineers to develop geospatial models of housing price dynamics and identify areas at increased risk of gentrification.

EDUCATION

Columbia University

- PhD in Sustainable Development
- New York, NY, USA • 08/2026 – Present

Georgia Institute of Technology

- Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88
- Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 12/2025

Indiana State University

- Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85
- Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024
- Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

- Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94
- Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020
- Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Heidelberg University

- Master of Science (audited) in Economics
- Heidelberg, DE • 07/2017 – 06/2018

Mercer University

- Bachelor in Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91
- Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017
- Thesis: Analyzing Regional Economic Impacts of Syrian Refugee Crisis in Turkey

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Donald M. Payne Fellow (05/2017) — \$100,000 fellowship with USAID
- Fulbright Scholar (05/2017) — Research Fellow at ZEW / Heidelberg, DE
- Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (05/2017) — in partnership with Amnesty International
- Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (05/2013) — \$240,000 merit scholarship
- Payne International Development Fellow (Not specified) — \$90,000 Graduate Fellowship with USAID
- Fulbright Graduate Research Award (Not specified) — \$10,000 Research Grant and Cultural Exchange Program

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices (12/2019) — UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab
- Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers (08/2018) — Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW) ([link](#))
- Gentrification or Revitalization? Ethical Investment in Urban Property Development (04/2017) — National Conference on Undergraduate Research
- Economic Impact Assessment of Historic Property Rehabilitation in Macon, GA (04/2017) — Society of Business, Industry, and Economics Conference
- “OurBlock” - Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform (03/2017) — Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition
- “How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa (10/2016) — Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum
- “Bloomfield 2020” – Neighborhood Economic Development Plan (04/2016) — Clinton Global Initiative University at Berkeley, CA
- Autonomous Drone Deployment Grid for Improved Wildfire Response in California (05/2020) — UC Berkeley: Innovations in Disaster Response Showcase
- The End of Schengen? Reforms to the Dublin Regulation and EU Asylum Policy (08/2017) — Humanity in Action International Conference in Strasbourg, FR

SKILLS

Applied Economics & Research Methods: Applied Econometrics, Mathematical Statistics, Labor Economic Research, Applied Mathematics, Development Economics, GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE), Program Evaluation, Empirical Policy Analysis, Spanish - Professional, German - Intermediate, Information Communications Technology

AI, Machine Learning & Automation: Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Artificial Neural Networks, Large Language Models, CrewAI, AutoGen, LangChain, Tableau, PowerBI, Google Earth Engine

Programming & Data Engineering: Python, R, JavaScript, Stata, MatLab, Excel, SQL, Azure, GCP